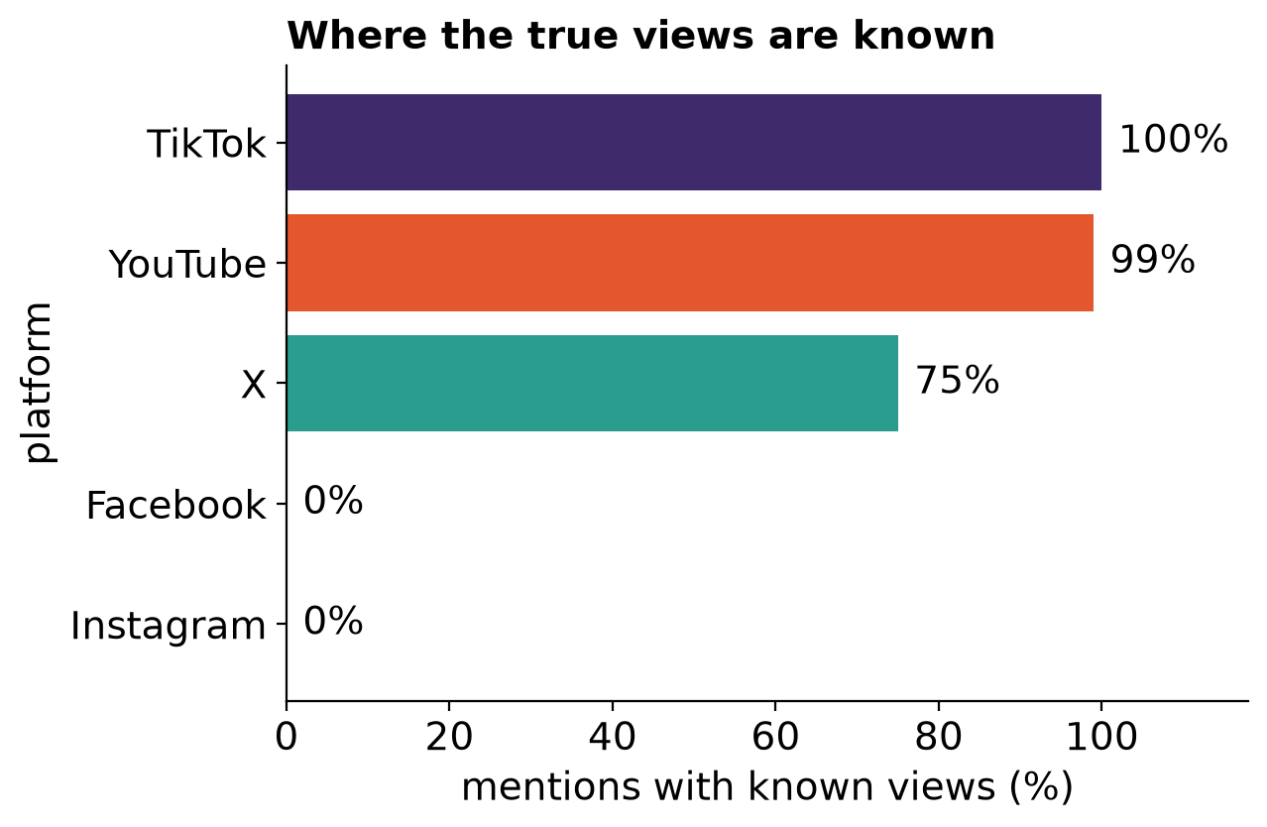
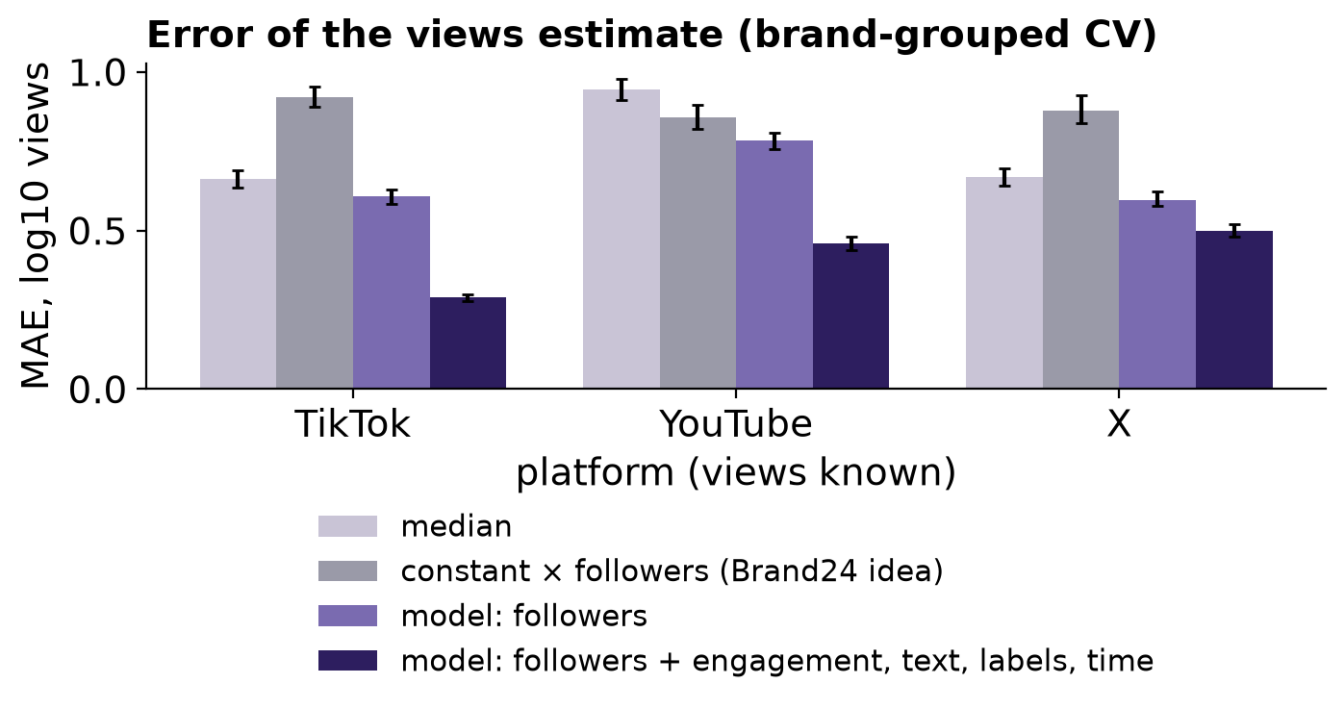
We know views on only three of five platforms, and Brand24's rule on X is off by a factor of about 12



- **TikTok and YouTube:** Brand24 reach is exactly the view count, so this is our ground truth.
- **X:** views exist for 75% of posts, and Brand24's reach is a separate estimate that is off by 1.08 log10 on average.
- **Facebook and Instagram:** no views at all, so no estimate can be checked directly.

12,500 mentions, 2,500 per platform. The sample is not uniform in time (about 85% from April to August 2026).

Views are explained mainly by likes and comments, not by followers, text or mention type

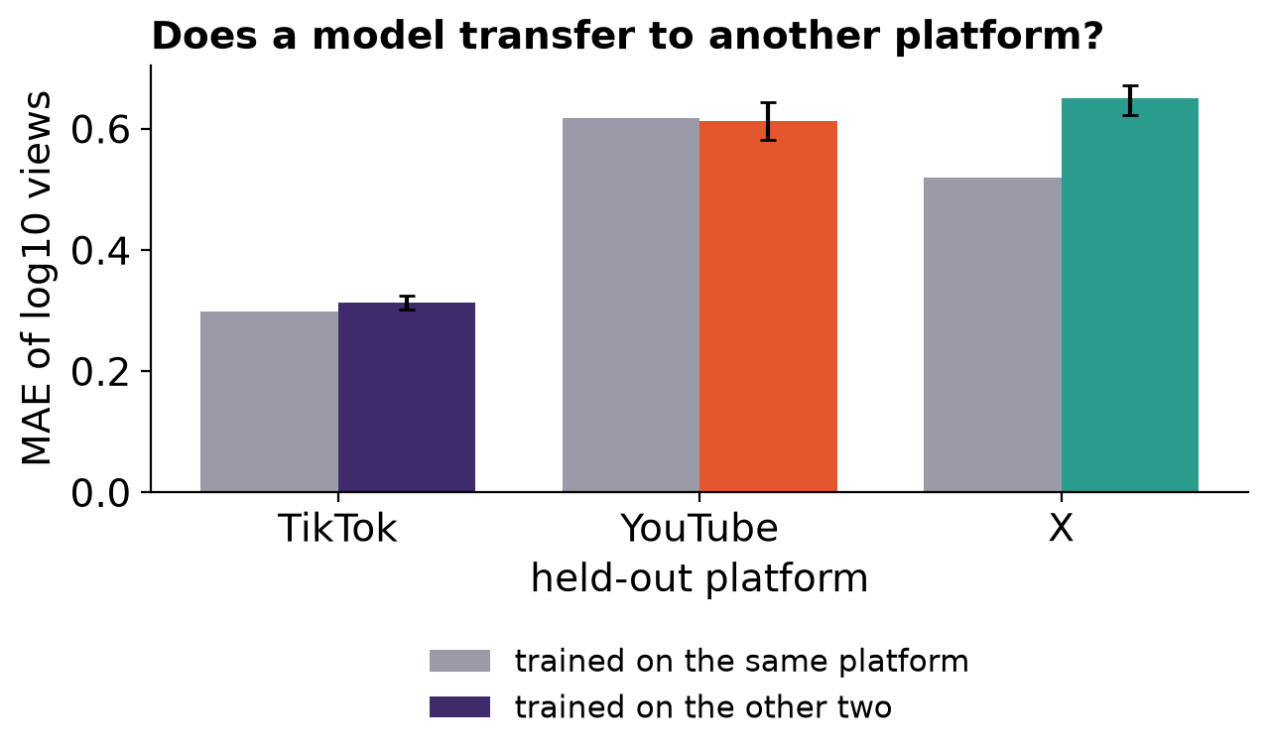


- **Engagement:** adding likes, comments and shares cuts the error from 0.61 to 0.29 on TikTok and from 0.78 to 0.46 on YouTube.
- **Constant × followers:** the worst model, worse than guessing the median on TikTok and X.
- **Text, our labels, time:** do not improve the result beyond noise.

MAE on log10: 0.3 means a typical error of about a factor of 2. Validation: 5 brand groups, bars = 95% CI (brand-cluster bootstrap). Association, not cause.

3 · TRANSFER TO PLATFORMS WITHOUT GROUND TRUTH

On Facebook and Instagram views can only be estimated, with an uncertainty of about ×14 each way



- **Transfers well:** on TikTok and YouTube the error after training on other platforms is 0.31 and 0.61, as good as training on the platform itself.
- **Facebook:** Brand24 reports about 21 times more than engagement implies, but there is no ground truth.
- **Caution:** intervals built from other platforms cover only 82% of cases against a 90% target, so they are optimistic.

Labels (type, sentiment) come from an AI instrument: kappa 0.77-0.79 and 0.71-0.73 between three models. Consistency, not accuracy.